language and practice of diplomacy was thoroughly degraded. In dealing with these totalitarian states, the old techniques of diplomacy seemed quite inadequate as diplomats of these totalitarian regimes became agents of conquest, double-dealing and espionage. Lord Vansittart (The Decline of Diplomacy, "*Foreign Affairs*, XXVIII, January, 1950) remarked that the object of totalitarian diplomacy, quite contrary to the eighteenth or nineteenth century diplomacy, was to create and maintain 'bad' relations among states.

Summit Diplomacy: This involves the direct participation of foreign ministers, Heads of States and Heads of Governments in diplomatic negotiations. This is nothing new and, during the course of Second World War and even in the post-War years, a number of personal meetings were held between Churchill and Roosevelt. The meeting of 1941 resulting in the signing of Atlantic Charter, the Teheran meeting with Stalin, the Yalta (February, 1945) and the Potsdam Conferene (July–August, 1945) are the most noteworthy. Meetings of Asian and African Prime Ministers, either through exchange of visits on a bilateral basis or at major international conferences, have been quite frequent in the past and also in the present, such as the Asian–African Conference at Bandung in 1955, Conference of Non-Aligned states in Belgrade in 1961 and in Cairo in 1964, the meetings of OAU, SAARC and other international and regional organizations.

Personal Diplomacy: Personal diplomacy also takes other forms where the normal channels of diplomacy are used only to a limited degree. Heads of states have embarked on a practice of using their personal agents or representatives to handle delicate problems in international relations. They even sometimes grow a tendency to consult their personal favourites rather than the foreign ministers. This has been a practice for many decades as Henry Wriston* pointed out in his study of *Executive Agents in American Foreign Relations* that they have been employed in American diplomatic relations from the colonial times. Wriston's reliance on Colonel House and Roosevelt's on Harry Hopkins are best known examples. Besides employing personal agents, another very common practice, among Heads of states is to directly approach his counterpart in the other country. Churchill and Roosevelt developed this practice to a